

Samsung Galaxy Z Fold5

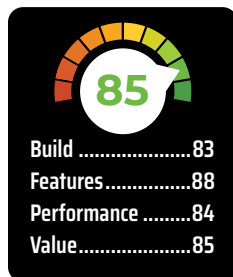
Incremental upgrade but still the foldable to beat

The Samsung Galaxy Z Fold5 and Samsung Galaxy Z Flip5 recently launched in Seoul, South Korea to much fanfare, and I was there to witness the unveiling. While the Z Flip5 definitely got the most love in terms of new aesthetics and features, the Z Fold5 also saw some incremental improvements. The foldable smartphone market is not as barren as it used to be. Competition from the likes of OPPO, Huawei, Tecno, Honor, and even Google means that Samsung can no longer be complacent if they're to win the foldable race. So, is the Samsung Galaxy Z Fold5 still the foldable to beat in 2023 and is Samsung playing it too safe? I spent just over a week testing the Samsung Galaxy Z Fold 5 and here's what I found out.

BUILD AND DESIGN

At first glance, the Galaxy Z Fold5 is nearly indistinguishable from its predecessor. It is only when you hold these devices side by side, you will notice a couple of meaningful changes. The thickness is down to 13.4 mm (folded) as compared to 15.8 mm on the Z Fold4 and it's 10 g lighter than its predecessor.

Dimensions and weight aside, the Galaxy Z Fold 5 also packs a re-engineered hinge design, dubbed 'Flex Hinge'. The two halves of the foldable display sit flush against each other, so there's no gap down the middle of the phone that gathers dust. The crease is still visible though, no tangible improvements there. The hinge is smooth, silent and opens at various angles. There's no creaking at all. The chassis of the phone uses Samsung's Armor Aluminium that's not as scratch and dent-resistant as stainless steel, but it does the job. The cover screen still has a really tall aspect ratio that doesn't lend



itself well to typing – especially if you are someone with stubby fingers. My only gripe is the cover display that honestly should have gotten at least slightly wider by the 5th iteration of this foldable. Oh, and another tiny gripe – there's still no S Pen included. The Z Fold5 does support the S Pen but it does not come in the retail box or inside the foldable's body. There is an S Pen cover on the Samsung website for the Z Fold5 but it will cost you around ₹8K.

DISPLAY

The displays on the Samsung Galaxy Z Fold5 have the same size and aspect ratio as their predecessor. The clarity and colour reproduction of both displays is top-notch. Visuals look absolutely stunning, HDR content looks punchy and vibrant, and the inner display is an absolute unit with great immersive qualities. Bezel size is the

same as last year, no improvements here; and of course, the cover display's aspect ratio is too narrow still. Using a lux meter, I measured a maximum brightness of 1,512 nits on Auto Brightness Mode under direct sunlight. So, you needn't worry about whether the display will be readable in bright daylight. The outer display has fantastic viewing angles, but the inner one's viewing angles are mediocre.

Head on, the display looks great. This is one of the best content consumption experiences you can get on a smartphone. Gaming is also a great experience. The crease is still visible but when you're watching content head-on, you will not notice it too much unless you really look for it. Overall, the Fold5 has some of the most gorgeous displays on foldables devices in the market; this time brighter than ever before.

PERFORMANCE

The Samsung Galaxy Z Fold 5 got a whopping 1.5+ million score on AnTuTu which obliterates the Z Fold4's 937,628 score. In fact, this is the highest AnTuTu score we've ever gotten on a phone we've tested in the Digit Test Labs! The Galaxy Z Fold5 beats out all competitors and the story repeats itself in GeekBench and PCMark Work. In 3D Mark Wild Life Extreme, the Z Fold5 got the best score out of all phones we've tested. GFXBench also saw the Z Fold5 output some of the highest scores to date! Benchmarks don't always tell the full story, but in this case, they do.

The Fold 5 breezes through daily tasks, intensive games, and multitasking without breaking a sweat. The only place where I saw it heat a bit was clicking photos and shooting 4K/8K video – but it never got too hot to the touch. Gaming is a great experience as well. I played games such as Call of Duty: Mobile, Asphalt 9 Legends, and Genshin Impact; all of which ran buttery smooth at maximum or close to maximum graphics. I even ran the CPU Throttling Test on the Samsung Galaxy Z Fold 5 and the phone throttled to 77 per cent of its peak performance after 30 minutes, which meets expectations.